

The fallout from the trial continued until October 2011, when Chester's son Robert (Bobby) Waxman was sentenced to eight years in prison for stealing almost \$18 million from Philip Services Corp., one of the spinoffs from the family business.

Bobby Waxman bought copper on delayed payment terms from a supplier and then immediately sold the copper at a loss to companies he controlled that in turn sold it at a profit, often back to the original supplier.

Like father, like son.

Bobby wasn't able to pay the legal bills for his defense because he had been bankrupted by the ruling against his family in the civil suit.⁴

It's too bad there wasn't a matriarch or another elder family member to keep members of the Waxman family in check.

BROTHERS' PROMISE TURNS INTO A FAMILY FEUD

Other times, it's not so clear that a family member's intentions are malicious. Take, for example, the case of the Demoulas family.

There could be a simple misunderstanding that boils over and becomes a family feud.

Two brothers, Mike (Telemachus) and George Demoulas, the children of Greek immigrants, bought their parents' deli and transformed it into a modern supermarket chain. They made a promise to each other that if one of them died the surviving brother would provide for the other's family. In 1971 George died of a heart attack while vacationing in Greece.

Mike provided for his brother's family, buying them luxury condos, and a new income-generating business by selling out their share of the supermarket chain. The supermarket business kept growing, but Mike launched a new chain called Market Basket that did even better.

In 1990 George's heirs filed a lawsuit against their uncle, alleging that he had defrauded them out of all but 8 percent of the company stock. They also accused Mike of diverting profits into a new chain of grocery stores owned only by his side of the family.⁵ The courts agreed with George's family and